	Swarm	Kubernetes
Overseen by	Docker	CNCF
Installation	Simple	Complex
Learning curve	Easy	Difficult
Feature set	Smaller	Large
Built-in autoscaling?	No	Yes
Community support	Good	Excellent

Although Swarm still has its place, Kubernetes seems to have gained a lot of traction and mindshare, and is fast becoming the de facto standard for orchestration. In fact, in a nod to this, Docker has added built-in Kubernetes support out of the box.[5] In reality, Swarm vs. Kubernetes is not an either or: it's worth spending some time to become familiar with both and having both options available to you.

With that in mind, Swarm is going to be our focus in the remaining chapters. It has a simpler conceptual model and more succinct config, making it a better learning tool. Picking up Kubernetes will be easier having experienced Swarm, since you'll have a good feel for how orchestrators work.

One final point: although Swarm and Kubernetes are the two main orchestrators, some hosting providers have their own, platform-specific orchestration layer—notably, Amazon Elastic Container Service (Amazon ECS).

IaaS vs. CaaS

Now that we have a better understanding of where container orchestrators fit in, there's still a choice to be made if you're considering deploying containers to the cloud. You can either manage things at the infrastructure level and set up the orchestrator yourself, or you can use a container platform that handles the underlying infrastructure and provides a preinstalled orchestrator ready for you to deploy and scale your containers.

The former—known as Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) platforms—are bare-bones offerings. They give you all the low-level building blocks to create the environment for your applications to run. As you would expect, this gives you the most flexibility and customization in terms of tailoring your environment for your own needs. However, you have to do the work of provisioning your instances, configuring them, and installing your orchestration layer.

5. https://www.docker.com/products/orchestration